

RNN applications

§1. Logistic map

- A discrete dynamical system described by the difference eqn.

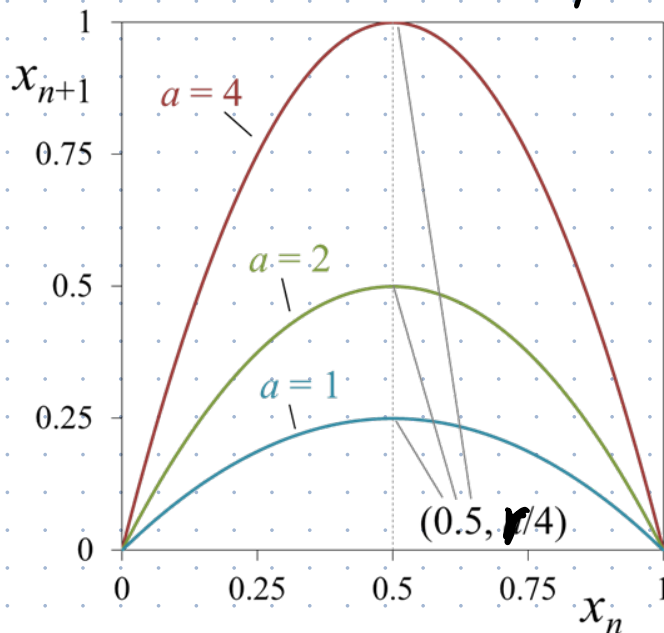
$$x_{n+1} = r x_n (1 - x_n)$$

- An iconic example of how complex, chaotic behavior can arise from very simple nonlinear dynamical equations

- $x \in [0, 1]$
 $r \in [1, 4]$

- A map $f: x \mapsto rx(1-x)$

- The map can be graphed by plotting the function $f(x) = rx(1-x)$



The peak is located at

$$x = \frac{1}{2}, \text{ where } f\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) = \frac{r}{4}$$

If $1 \leq r \leq 4$, then $x \in [0, 1]$.

- The dynamical system generates a sequence (an orbit) starting from an initial value x_0

$$x_1 = f(x_0) = r x_0 (1 - x_0)$$

$$x_2 = f(x_1) = r x_1 (1 - x_1)$$

$$x_3 = f(x_2) = r x_2 (1 - x_2)$$

$$x_4 = \dots$$

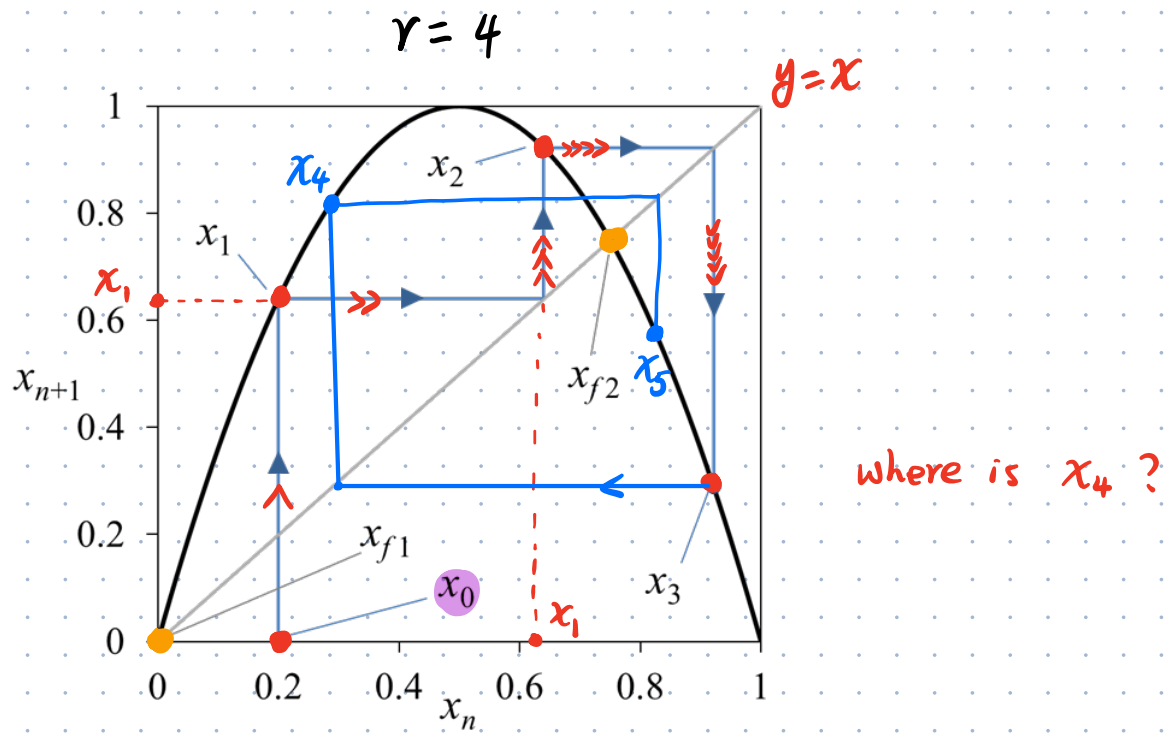
- The logistic map may become chaotic.
- fixed points:

$$r x (1 - x) = x$$

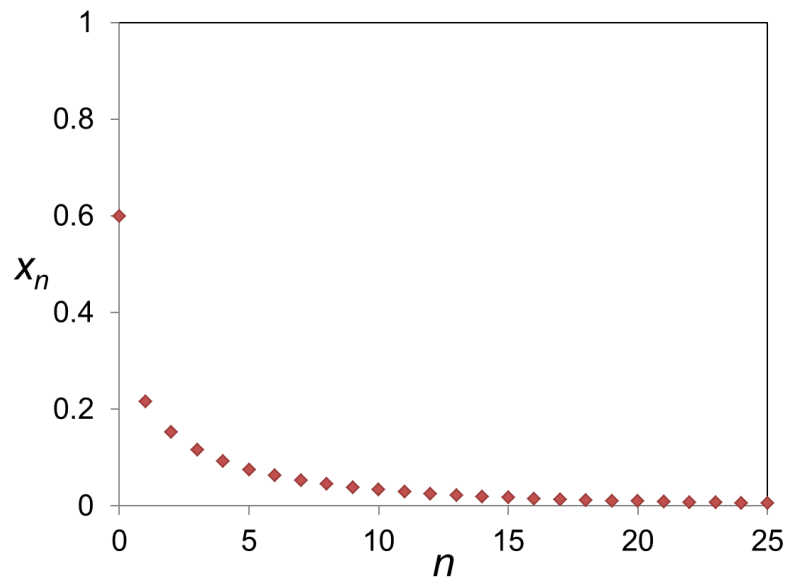
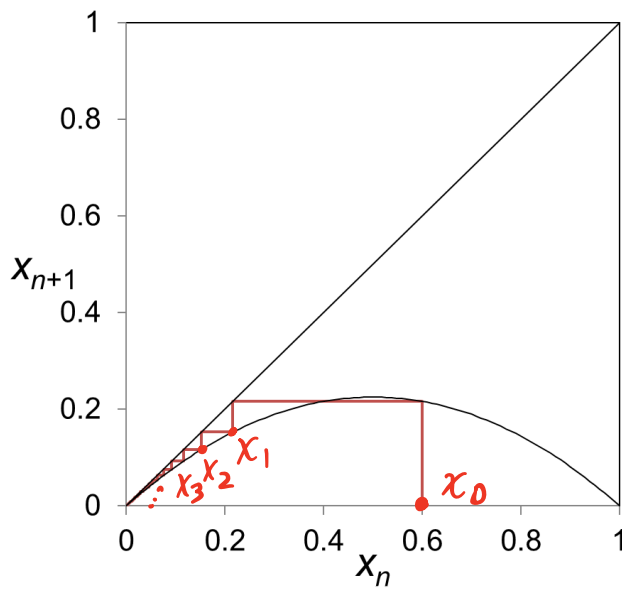
$$\Rightarrow \begin{cases} x = 0 \equiv x_{f_1} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{or } \begin{cases} x = 1 - \frac{1}{r} \equiv x_{f_2} \end{cases}$$

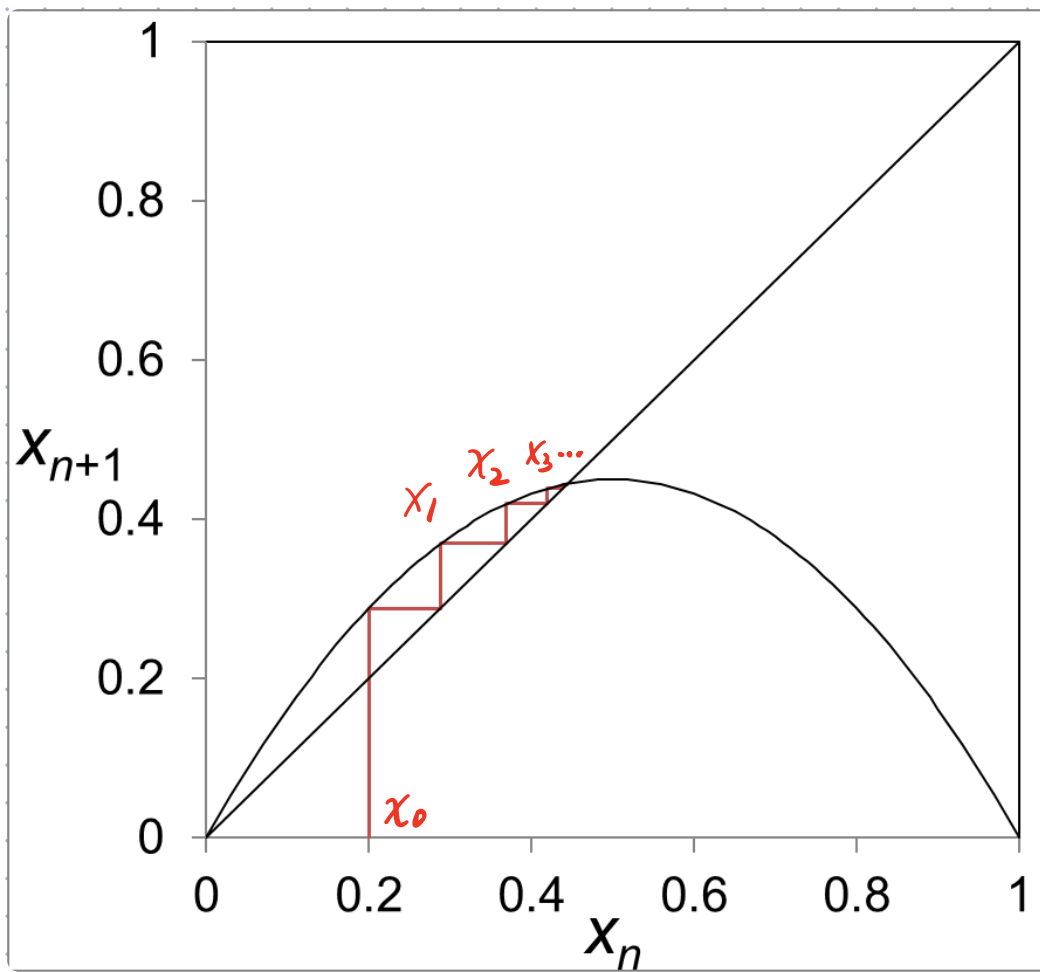
see orange dots below



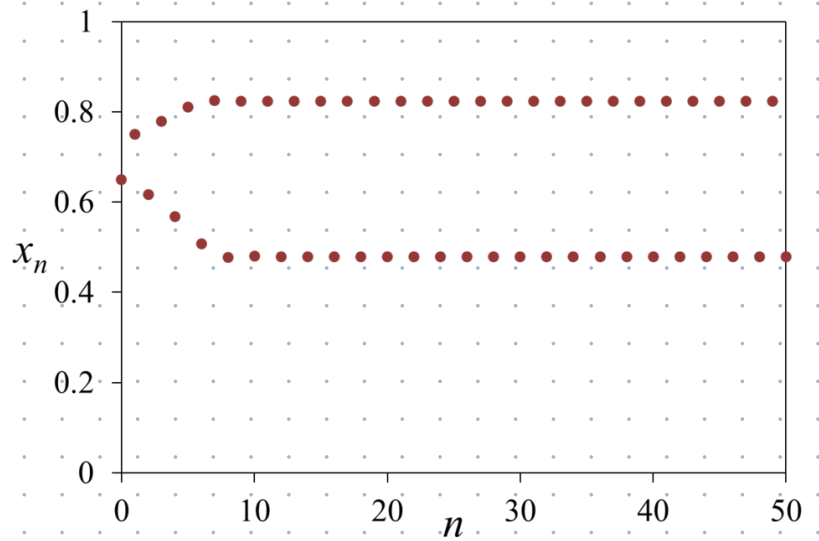
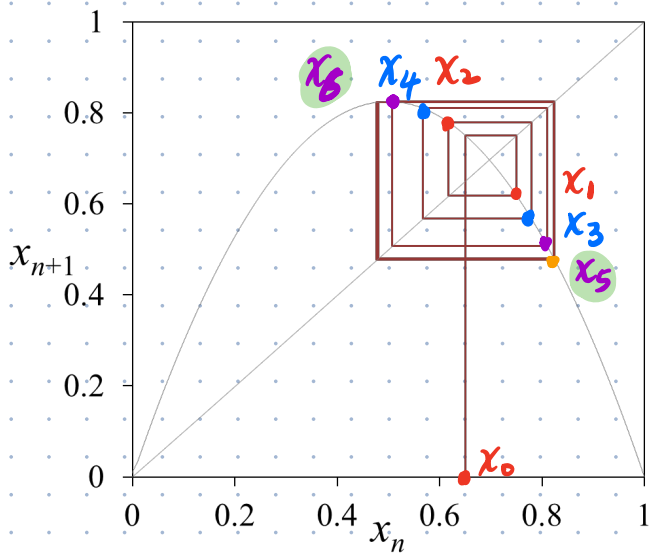
for $r=4$, the mapping doesn't repeat, $\rightarrow$ chaos.



for small r , e.g. $r=0.9$, the trajectory converges to fixed points, here, $x=0$

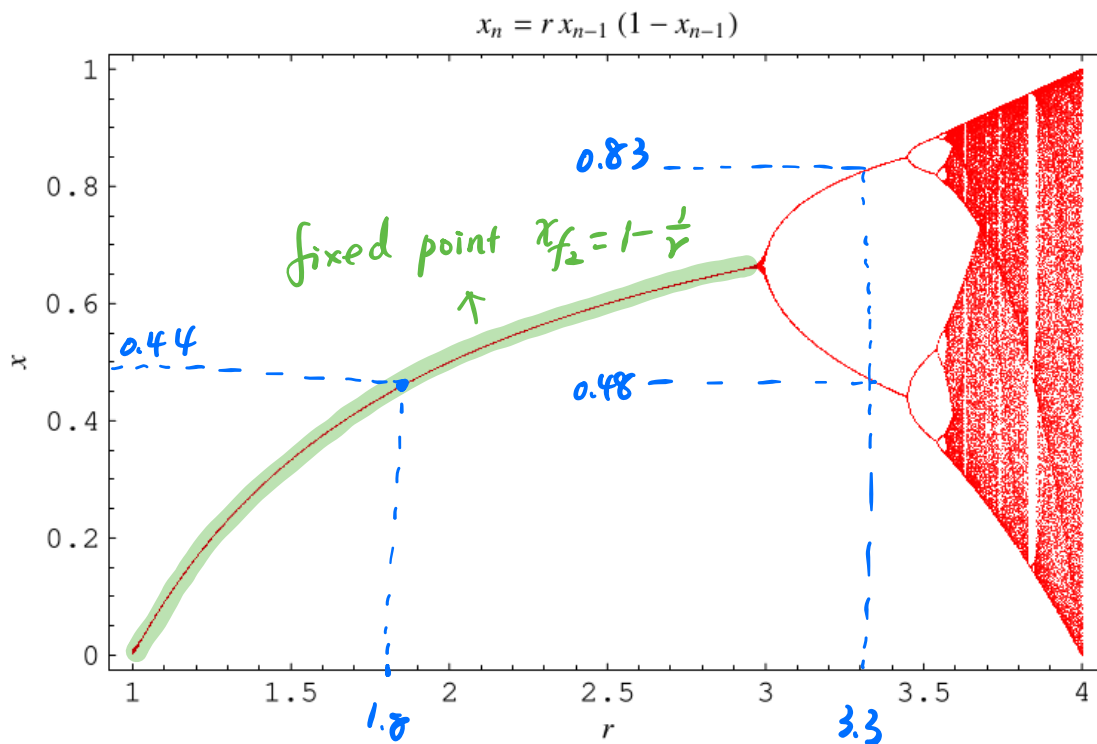


Here, $r=1.8$. $x_0 = 0.2$, the mapping converges
to the other fixed points $x = 1 - \frac{1}{r} = 0.444\dots$



Here, $r = 3.3$. The orbit cycles through the same values periodically. Here, there are two periodic points $\begin{cases} \approx 0.48 \\ \approx 0.83 \end{cases}$

For larger r , there can be four, eight, ..., periodic points.



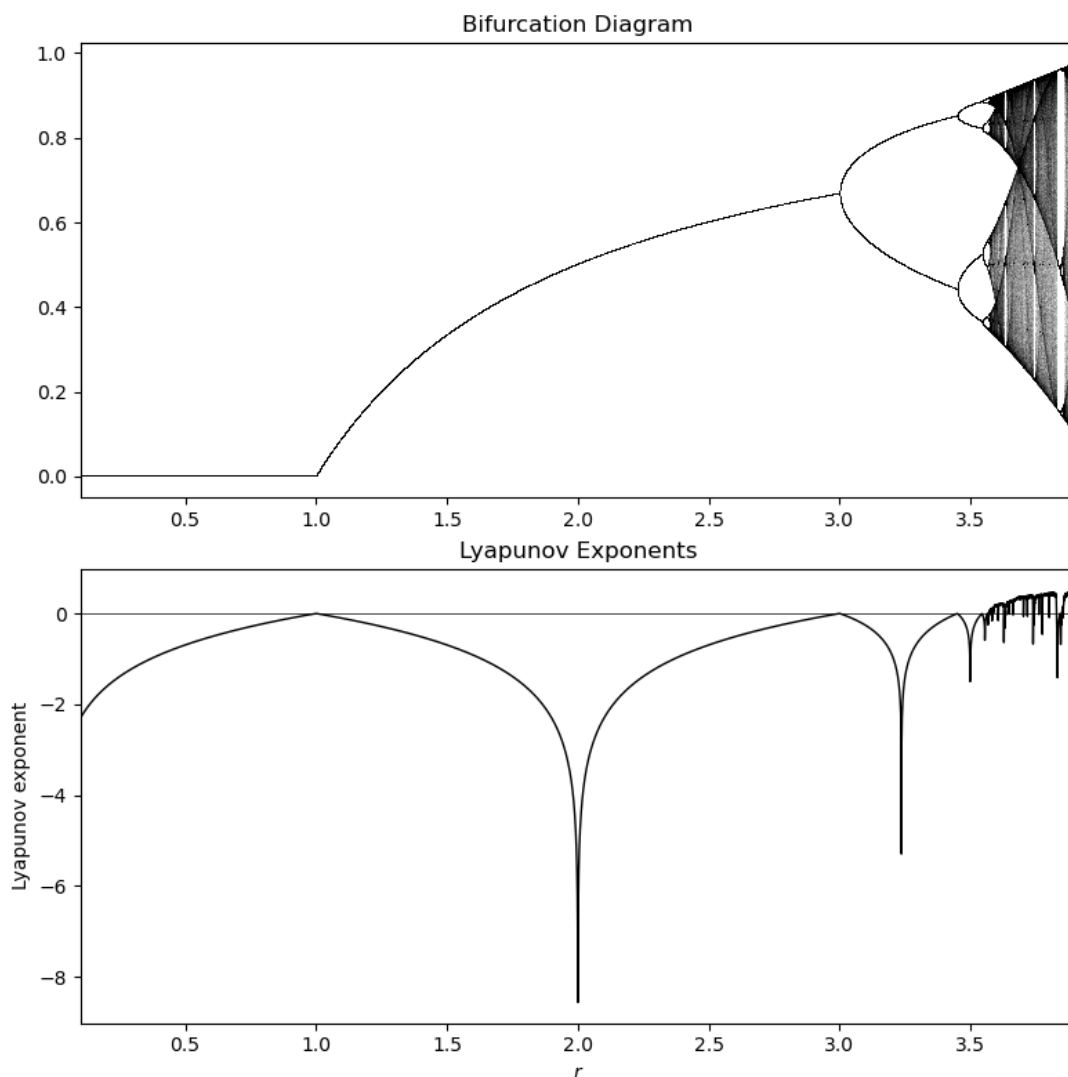
For r close to 4, chaos. $\rightarrow$ very sensitive to initial condition

$$\lambda = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} \ln |f'(x_i)|$$

It characterizes the distance between two orbits.

$\lambda > 0$: the system is sensitive to initial condition

$\lambda \leq 0$: the system is not sensitive to initial condition



Summary

- Logistic map is deterministic
- Simple equation $\rightarrow$ complex behavior
- For certain r , system becomes chaotic (chaos is not randomness)
- Tiny change in initial condition $\rightarrow$ huge divergence.
- Short-term predictable, long-term unpredictable

★ Can a neural network approximate chaotic dynamics?

★ What does it mean to learn chaos?

★ Can we predict the future of chaotic dynamics?

★ Logistic map is a discrete-time dynamical system. It evolves step by step. Each step depends on previous value.

★ This is exactly the structure RNN is designed for.

- It models temporal dependence
- Hidden state acts like internal memory.
- It can approximate nonlinear mapping.

★ develop a RNN to learn the underlying dynamical law of the logistic map.